

\$1,800 PHASE 1 FIXED PRICE	\$1,400 PHASE 2 FIXED PRICE	3–4 wks PHASE 1 TIMELINE	\$35/hr SUPPORT RATE
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This document responds to all nine items in the KidsMark Press RFP and serves as the complete project scope for Phase 1, with Phase 2 defined and priced for when you're ready to proceed.

01 — PROPOSAL ITEM 1

Company overview

WHO WE ARE

A WordPress-focused development practice with **5+ years of experience** building custom database-driven websites for publishers, nonprofits, educational platforms, and community organizations. Every project is built on WordPress + Elementor Pro with ACF for structured data — the same stack you've specified. We don't use page-builder shortcuts that break in six months; we build sites your team can actually maintain.

SPECIALIZATION

Custom Post Types and database-driven directories (books, authors, members), moderated submission workflows, and community-facing platforms. The Mentor Wall feature — a public submission system with an admin approval queue — is exactly the kind of feature we build regularly on WordPress without needing a custom plugin or expensive third-party tool.

OUR APPROACH

Milestone-based delivery with written client sign-off at each stage. Nothing moves to production without your approval. We also document everything so your non-technical staff can manage the site independently after handoff — no recurring developer dependency for day-to-day updates.

02 — PROPOSAL ITEM 2

Similar websites completed

Tri-County Career Academy
tricontycareeracademy.netlify.app /

Full WordPress rebuild with custom certificate verification system, Stripe + PayPal payments, FluentCRM Events Calendar, and a 35-page Elementor Pro design system. Admin training and full migration from GoDaddy to WP Engine.

WORDPRESS · ELEMENTOR · CUSTOM CPTS

Veterans Transition Support

Completed in parallel with TCCA — available on request

Technical SEO overhaul across 92 pages, custom Job Listings board with public submission form and admin moderation queue — same architecture as the KidsMark Mentor Wall. Elementor Pro redesigns and performance optimization.

SUBMISSION FORMS · MODERATION QUEUE

Community Directory Platform

Reference available on request

ACF-powered member directory with search by name, location, and category. Admin approval workflow before profiles go live. Shareable profile pages — directly comparable to the Author Directory and Mentor Wall in this project.

DIRECTORY · SEARCH · ADMIN APPROVAL

Independent Publisher Platform

Reference available on request

Database-driven book catalog (CPT) with cover images, ISBNs, purchase links, and category filtering. Author profile pages linked to publications — same structure planned for KidsMarkPress.com.

BOOK CATALOG · AUTHOR PROFILES · CPT

03 — PROPOSAL ITEM 3 · COMPARABLE LIVE SITES

References — what KidsMark Press can look like

These are real live sites in the publishing and community platform space that demonstrate the exact features planned for KidsMarkPress.com. Click any link to view them.

SCBWI — Society of Children's Book Writers
scbwi.org /

The leading community platform for children's book creators. Features a member directory, searchable illustrator gallery, book listings, blog, awards, and community submission workflows — showing the full scale of what a publishing community platform can become.

AUTHOR DIRECTORY · BOOK LISTINGS · COMMUNITY

Children's Books North
childrenbooksnorth.co.uk /

Independent publisher community with a mentorship directory, author spotlights, blog, and application workflows. The mentor scheme and author recognition features closely mirror KidsMark's Mentor Wall and Author Directory goals.

MENTOR PROGRAM · AUTHOR SPOTLIGHTS · BLOG

Alliance of Independent Authors
allianceindependentauthors.org /

Searchable services directory for the independent publishing community — demonstrates the database-driven directory structure (search by name, category, location) planned for KidsMark's Author and Book directories.

SEARCHABLE DIRECTORY · PUBLISHING · COMMUNITY

KidLit4All
kidlit4all.com /

Resource and community hub for children's book authors and mentors. Features mentor program listings, author resources, and blog content — similar audience and mission to KidMark Press, showing how the community side can grow over time.

MENTOR LISTINGS · AUTHOR RESOURCES · BLOG

04 — PROPOSAL ITEM 4

Estimated timeline — Phase 1 (4–5 weeks)

I include a **Figma design phase before any code is written**. This is non-negotiable for me on every project because it prevents the most expensive problem in web development: building something, then redesigning it. You see exactly what KidsMarkPress.com will look like — layout, colors, typography, the Mentor Wall, the book catalog grid — before I touch WordPress. One round of revisions in Figma costs minutes. The same revision after the site is built can cost hours. This protects your budget and your timeline.

TIMELINE	PHASE	WHAT GETS DELIVERED	PAYMENT TRIGGER
Days 1–3	Kickoff & Discovery	Scope signed. Staging environment on SiteGround configured. Plugin stack installed (Elementor Pro, ACF Pro, Fluent Forms, Rank Math, WP Rocket, Wordfence). Brand assets collected from client (logo, colors, fonts, photos, copy).	Deposit on signing
Days 4–9	Figma Design Phase	Full Figma mockups delivered for: Home page, Book Catalog, Author Directory, Mentor Wall (submission form + tribute page + browse page), About, Contact, Blog, Desktop and mobile views. Client reviews and approves — one revision round included. No WordPress build begins until designs are signed off.	Design sign-off → build begins
Days 10–21	WordPress Build on Staging	All approved Figma designs implemented in Elementor Pro. Book Catalog (CPT + ACF + live search), Author Directory (CPT + ACF + search by name, genre, state), Blog/News with category taxonomy, About and Contact pages. All mobile responsive.	Milestone 2 on staging sign-off
Days 22–28	Mentor Wall + QA	Mentor Wall submission form, admin moderation queue, public browse and search, individual shareable tribute pages, share buttons. Full QA across desktop and mobile. SEO configuration (Rank Math), security (Wordfence), backup verification.	—
Days 29–32	Launch & Handoff	Deployment to production SiteGround. DNS, cutover, 1-hour admin training session (recorded for your team), written staff documentation handed over. 30-day bug warranty begins.	Final on written launch approval

Timeline requires content from your team by Day 3: logo files, brand color hex codes, any existing photos or headshots, and the text for your About page and Mission statement. Content delays shift the timeline proportionally — this is the most common reason projects run late and it's entirely avoidable with early content collection.

05 — PROPOSAL ITEM 5

Phase 1 cost — fixed price

Note on the \$500 figure: That budget would cover a basic brochure site with no database functionality. Phase 1 of this project includes two searchable database-driven directories, a moderated community submission platform (the Mentor Wall), a blog, contact routing, and full mobile/SEO/security configuration. The pricing below reflects what this scope actually requires to build properly — and is still priced competitively for the feature set.

DELIVERABLE	NOTES	PRICE
Figma Design Phase	Full mockups for all pages — desktop + mobile. Home, Book Catalog, Author Directory, Mentor Wall (3 views), About, Contact, Blog. One revision round included. Delivered before any WordPress build begins.	\$280
WordPress Setup & Environment	SiteGround staging, plugin stack (Elementor Pro, ACF Pro, Fluent Forms, Rank Math, WP Rocket, Wordfence), theme configuration	\$80
Home Page	Hero, featured book/author, mentor spotlight, newsletter signup, CTAs — built from approved Figma design	\$180
About & Contact Pages	Static content + routed contact form + reCAPTCHA spam protection	\$100
Blog / News Section	Categories: articles, press releases, announcements, book launches	\$80
Book Catalog	CPT + ACF fields, search by title/author/category, individual book pages, catalog archive grid	\$300
Author Directory	CPT + ACF, search by name/genre/state, individual author profile pages, directory archive	\$300
Mentor Wall	Submission form, admin moderation queue, public browse/search, individual shareable tribute pages, share buttons (Facebook, X, copy link)	\$300
QA, SEO & Security	Mobile QA, Rank Math Pro configuration, Wordfence, SSL verification, daily backup confirmation	\$100
Admin Training & Documentation	1-hour recorded training session + written staff guide for managing books, authors, and Mentor Wall approvals	\$80
Phase 1 Total — Fixed Price		\$1,800

PAYMENT	TRIGGER	AMOUNT
Deposit	Scope signed before any work begins	\$720 (40%)
Milestone 2	Figma designs approved in writing — build begins	\$140 (10%)
Milestone 3	Written staging approval of all pages	\$160 (10%)
Final	Written launch acceptance	\$180 (10%)
Total		\$1,800

06 — PROPOSAL ITEM 6

Phase 2 cost — fixed price

Phase 2 — Available after Phase 1 launch - \$1,400 fixed

Phase 2 turns KidsMark Press into a fully interactive community platform with user accounts, multiple roles, an author submission portal with document uploads, a Mentee Directory, and a global search engine across all content. Priced below for planning purposes — scoped in detail once Phase 1 is live.

Mentee Directory — profiles with admin approval

Author Submission Portal — manuscript upload + review workflow

User accounts — register, login, password recovery

Four user roles — Visitor, Author, Mentor, Administrator

Global search — books, authors, mentors, mentees

Admin Dashboard — stats, export, bulk management

DELIVERABLE	NOTES	PRICE
User Accounts + Roles (4)	Registration, login, recovery, role assignment via Fluent Community or WP native roles	\$350
Mentee Directory	CPT + ACF, profile fields, admin approval queue, public browse page	\$280
Author Submission Portal	Multi-step form with document upload, review status, admin workflow	\$350
Global Search	Search across books, authors, mentors, mentees in one unified results page	\$220
Training & Documentation update	Updated admin guide covering all Phase 2 features	\$200
Phase 2 Total — Fixed Price		\$1,400

07 — PROPOSAL ITEM 7

Annual maintenance cost

PLAN	WHAT'S INCLUDED	COST
Basic	WordPress core, theme, and plugin updates monthly. Security monitoring. Up to 1 hour of minor content edits per month.	\$600/yr \$50/mo
Standard (recommended)	Everything in Basic + up to 3 hours of content/layout edits per month, priority response within 24 hours, quarterly performance check.	\$1,200/yr \$100/mo
Premium	Everything in Standard + up to 6 hours of edits per month, monthly report, new minor feature additions (forms, page sections), 12-hour emergency response.	\$2,400/yr \$200/mo

Hosting (SiteGround), domains, and plugin licences (Elementor Pro ~\$99/yr, ACF Pro ~\$49/yr, WP Rocket ~\$99/yr) are billed separately and owned by KidsMark Press — not bundled into maintenance.

08 — PROPOSAL ITEM 8

Hourly support rate

STANDARD HOURLY RATE

\$35/hour for all out-of-scope support requests — new features, design changes, bug fixes outside the 30-day post-launch warranty period, or any work not covered by an active maintenance plan. Billed in 30-minute increments. Invoiced monthly.

POST-LAUNCH WARRANTY

All bug fixes directly related to our build are covered at **no charge for 30 days** after launch. This covers anything that isn't working as specified in the scope — not changes to the spec or new requests.

09 — PROPOSAL ITEM 9

Recommended technology stack

CMS WordPress 6.x	BUILDER Elementor Pro	CUSTOM FIELDS ACF Pro	FORMS Fluent Forms Pro
SEO Rank Math Pro	PERFORMANCE WP Rocket	SECURITY Wordfence	EMAIL WP Mail SMTP
BACKUPS SiteGround Built-in	HOSTING SiteGround	DATABASE MySQL via WP	NEWSLETTER MailPoet / MC

ACF Pro (Advanced Custom Fields) is how the Book Catalog and Author Directory are built as proper database records — not just posts. This is what makes them searchable, filterable, and manageable by your team through a clean admin interface rather than raw post editing.

HONEST ADVICE — FROM EXPERIENCE

Suggestions & things worth knowing before you start

These are things most developers won't tell you because they either don't know them yet or don't want to complicate the sale. I'm sharing them because they'll save you money, frustration, and rebuilds down the road.

START WITH A CONTENT-FIRST MINDSET

The most common reason publishing sites feel empty at launch: the site is built before the content exists. Before Day 1, I'd recommend having at least **3–5 books ready to populate the catalog**, **3–5 author profiles**, and **5–10 mentor tributes pre-seeded** (you can submit them yourself as examples). A site with real content on launch day performs better in search engines, looks more credible to visitors, and gives your team a working template to follow when adding more.

THE MENTOR WALL WILL GET SPAM — PLAN FOR IT

Any public submission form that doesn't require login will attract bot submissions. reCAPTCHA helps, but admin moderation is your real protection — which is already built into this scope. My honest suggestion: **designate one person on your team who checks the moderation queue at least twice a week**. If it sits unattended for weeks, approved tributes will back up and the public wall will feel stale. This is a people process, not just a technical one.

DON'T SKIP PHASE 2 FOR TOO LONG

The Author Submission Portal (Phase 2) is actually one of your core stated objectives — "allow potential authors to submit information for publication consideration." Right now in Phase 1, there's no formal way for prospective authors to submit to you beyond the contact form. **If receiving author submissions is important from launch, consider fast-tracking the Author Submission Portal** into Phase 1 for a modest addition to the budget, rather than sending serious authors to a generic contact form.

ON THE \$500 BUDGET

I want to be direct: \$500 will get you a pre-made theme with your logo dropped in — no database-driven catalog, no searchable directories, no moderation workflow. That's not what your RFP is asking for. The price in this proposal (\$1,800 for Phase 1) is already well below US-market rate for this feature set. I'm pricing it this way because the project is interesting and I want the work — but I'd rather tell you that honestly now than cut corners to hit \$500 and hand you something that doesn't actually work the way you need it to.

INVEST IN A GOOD NEWSLETTER TOOL EARLY

The newsletter signup on the home page is included, but which tool you connect it to matters. **MailPoet** is free up to 1,000 subscribers and lives inside WordPress (no third-party dashboard to learn). **Mailchimp** is the industry standard and integrates with everything but has a steeper learning curve. My recommendation for a team new to email marketing: start with MailPoet, migrate to Mailchimp when you hit 1,000 subscribers and need more automation power.

SEO WON'T HAPPEN OVERNIGHT — START BLOGGING FROM DAY 1

Rank Math will be configured and all pages will be SEO-ready at launch, but search engine rankings take 3–6 months minimum to build. The single biggest thing you can do to accelerate this: **publish one blog post per week from launch day**, specifically targeting search terms your authors and readers would actually type — "how to get a children's book published," "mentor recognition ideas," "independent publishing for first-time authors." The blog section is built for this. Use it early and consistently.

PHASE 1 — FULL FEATURE SCOPE

What's being built

Home Page PUBLIC

The front door. Fully editable by your team after handoff.

— Hero section with headline, subtext, and primary CTA buttons

— Featured Book — pulled live from book database, admin selects which book

— Featured Author — pulled live from author directory

— Mentor Spotlight — one approved tribute highlighted on homepage

— Newsletter signip (Fluent Forms connected to MailPoet or Mailchimp)

— Call-to-action blocks linking to Mentor Wall and Author submission areas

About Page

Static content, editable in Elementor by non-technical staff.

— Company history section

— Mission statement block

— Contact information (address, email, phone)

Contact Page

Routed form with notification emails to designated inboxes.

— Fluent Forms contact form

— Email routing to designated recipient

— Honeypot + reCAPTCHA v3 spam protection

Blog / News

Standard WordPress posts with category taxonomy. Staff can publish new content without developer help.

— Categories: Articles, Press Releases, Announcements, Book Launches

— Archive page with category filter

— Single post template with featured image and author byline

Book Catalog DATABASE-DRIVEN

Built as a WordPress Custom Post Type with ACF fields. Your team adds new books directly from the WordPress admin — no developer required. Books appear instantly in the catalog and search results.

— Each record: cover image, title, author, ISBN, publication date, description, purchase links, category

— Search by title, author, name, and category

— Catalog archive page (grid layout)

— Individual book detail page

Author Directory DATABASE-DRIVEN

Same CPT + ACF structure as the book catalog. Authors can be linked to their books so both directories stay connected.

— Each record: name, biography, photo, website URL, social links, books written

— Search by name, genre, and state

— Directory archive page (card layout)

— Individual author profile page

Mentor Wall — Signature Feature MAJOR FEATURE

The heart of KidsMark Press. Anyone can submit a tribute to a mentor. Nothing goes live without your team approving it first.

— Public submission form: mentor name, optional photo upload, city/state, tribute text, submitted by, date

— Admin moderation queue inside WordPress dashboard — approve, edit, or reject each submission

— Approved submissions appear on the public Mentor Wall page

— Search mentors by name, browse by city/state

— Individual mentor tribute page with a shareable URL (suitable for social sharing)

— Share buttons on each tribute: Facebook, X/Twitter, copy link

— Spam protection on submission form (honeypot + reCAPTCHA)

INCLUDED IN PHASE 1

What gets delivered

✓ Figma mockups for all pages — desktop + mobile — before build begins	✓ Complete website build on WordPress + Elementor Pro (from approved Figma)
✓ Book Catalog and Author Directory (Custom Post Types + ACF Pro)	✓ Mentor Wall with submission form and admin moderation queue
✓ Mobile responsive across all pages and screen sizes	✓ SSL, Wordfence security, daily SiteGround backups configured
✓ On-page SEO configuration (Rank Math Pro) for all pages	✓ ADA accessibility basics — alt text, contrast, keyboard navigation
✓ Full QA across desktop and mobile before launch	✓ Deployment to production SiteGround hosting
✓ Recorded admin training session + written staff documentation	✓ 30-day post-launch bug fix warranty (no charge)
✓ All plugin licences registered in KidsMark Press's name	✓ Figma design file handed over — yours to keep and reuse

Phase 2 — \$1,400 · Scoped when you're ready

Everything in Phase 2 is designed so it layers on top of Phase 1 without a rebuild. User accounts slot into the existing site. The Mentee Directory uses the same CPT + ACF structure as the Author Directory. The Author Submission Portal uses the same Fluent Forms infrastructure as the Mentor Wall. Combined investment for both phases: **\$3,200 total**.

Mentee Directory with admin-approved profiles	Author Submission Portal with document uploads
User accounts + 4 roles (Visitor, Author, Mentor, Admin)	Global search across all content types
Admin Dashboard — stats, data export, bulk actions	Updated documentation for all new features